

The ChatGPT Book Commands Playbook

100 ChatGPT codes to study any book, plus the four commands from the video: mind map, sketchnotes, flashcards and a comic page.

Why I stopped reading business books the slow way

Agency owners and solopreneurs spend hours on business books they half remember a week later. Highlighting takes time, and note-taking sessions take more.

This guide covers four ChatGPT commands that change that. Drop a book into the chat, type one command, and get the core ideas in a format your brain actually retains.

It works for a business book, a marketing framework or an industry report. You absorb it in minutes instead of hours.

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How it actually works

Every command starts from the same place: the book you dropped into the chat. What changes is the format that comes back.

1. Drop the book into ChatGPT.
2. Type one of the four commands: `/mindmap`, `/sketchnotes`, `/flashcards` or `/educationalcomics`.
3. Read or study what comes back, then run another command on the same book if you want a second format.

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The one thing almost everyone gets wrong

Most people pick one format and use it for everything. The four commands exist because people retain information in different ways.

WATCH OUT

Match the command to how you learn. If you process information better visually, `/educationalcomics` or `/mindmap` will stick better than a wall of text. If you need to memorize points, use `/flashcards`.

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The four commands and what each one builds

Here is what each command does, straight from the video.

COMMAND	WHAT CHATGPT BUILDS	BEST FOR
/mindmap	A mind map of the most important topics in the book	Seeing the big picture first
/sketchnotes	Handwritten-style summary notes	Quick review and skimming
/flashcards	Simple cards covering the key points	Memorizing ideas fast
/educationalcomics	The main idea as a visual comic page	Visual learners

Below is a prompt for each one. They are templates, so swap the bracketed parts for your own book and goal.

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Copy-paste prompts

MAP THE WHOLE BOOK

/mindmap

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Focus on the most important topics and how they connect.

HANDWRITTEN SUMMARY

/sketchnotes

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Summarize the key ideas as handwritten-style notes I can review in a few minutes.

MEMORIZE THE KEY POINTS

/flashcards

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Build simple cards for the key points so I can memorize them fast.

SEE THE MAIN IDEA

/educationalcomics

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Turn the main idea into a visual comic page.

Set it up in ChatGPT

1. Open a new ChatGPT chat and paste the priming instruction from the next section once, so ChatGPT knows what the slash codes mean.
2. Drop in the book, a chapter or a PDF. For a well-known book, the title and author are enough.
3. Type `/mindmap` and read the map first, so you know where each chapter fits.
4. Run `/sketchnotes` or `/flashcards` on the same book depending on whether you want to review or memorize.
5. Use `/educationalcomics` when you want the main idea as a single visual page.

QUICK TIPS

- Start with one book you actually plan to read this week, so you can check the output against what you remember.
- Run two commands on the same book. A mind map plus flashcards covers structure and memory.

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Combinations worth running

A few combinations that cover the common reading goals.

BEFORE I READ

`/mindmap`

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Show me the main topics so I know what to pay attention to.

AFTER I READ

`/flashcards`

Book: [BOOK TITLE]

Build cards for the key points from [CHAPTER OR TOPIC].

FOR A CLIENT FRAMEWORK

`/sketchnotes`

Document: [FRAMEWORK OR REPORT NAME]

Summarize it as handwritten-style notes I can reference on a client call.

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How the slash codes work

The full list below comes from Cindy Zhu's guide, 100 ChatGPT codes to study any book. A code is just a short label for an instruction. ChatGPT can run it in one of three ways.

1. Priming. Teach ChatGPT the codes once at the start of the chat, then use the short labels.
2. Custom GPT. Put all the definitions in a Custom GPT's instructions so the codes are always on.
3. Shorthand. ChatGPT often understands plain-language commands even without priming.

UNIVERSAL PRIMING INSTRUCTION (PASTE ONCE)

For the rest of this chat, when I type a code starting with a slash, run the matching instruction on whatever text I give you.

SOURCE GUIDE

The full guide by Cindy Zhu, with every code:

<https://cindyzhu.com.au/guides/chatgpt-codes-to-study-any-book>

Codes: 1. Understand a book

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/tldr	A 5-sentence summary
/bigidea	One thesis plus 3 supporting arguments
/chapters	A one-line summary of each chapter
/keytakeaways	The 10 most important actionable points
/themes	Recurring themes and where they show up
/premise	The author's core assumption and whether it is proven
/whoisitfor	The ideal reader and the problem the book solves
/arc	How the main idea develops through the book
/oneliner	A memorable one-sentence summary
/context	The historical and intellectual background

Codes: 2. Summarize and extract

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/summary200	A summary of exactly 200 words
/bullets	Clean bullet points grouped by subtopic
/quotes	The 10 most important verbatim quotes
/stats	Every statistic, with its source
/definitions	Key terms as a glossary
/examples	All real-world examples and case studies
/framework	Models, frameworks or step-by-step methods
/checklist	The advice turned into an actionable checklist
/objections	Counterarguments and the author's responses
/soundbites	8 punchy one-line insights

Codes: 3. Memorize and revise

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/clozecards	15 fill-in-the-blank cards
/ankicsv	A flashcard CSV you can import into Anki
/spacedplan	A 30-day spaced-repetition schedule
/mnemonics	Memory hooks for lists and sequences
/keywords10	10 anchor words for chapter recall
/quizme	An interactive drill, one question at a time
/recallgrid	A two-column self-test grid
/whatdidimiss	A gap analysis of your recall
/minitest	A 10-question mixed quiz with answers
/rapidfire	20 rapid question and answer pairs

Codes: 4. Study a topic fast

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/eli5	An explanation for a 5-year-old, with an analogy
/eli15	An explanation for a smart teenager, with an example
/prereqs	A map of the prerequisite knowledge
/analogy	3 everyday-life analogies
/firstprinciples	Break it down to basics, then rebuild it
/connectdots	How the chapter ideas connect
/whyitmatters	Why it matters and what happens if you ignore it
/commonconfusions	5 common misunderstandings
/crashcourse	A 10-minute crash course from zero
/compareideas	A two-column comparison table

Codes: 5. Turn it into practice

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/exercises	5 practice exercises, easy to hard
/scenario	A realistic problem-solving scenario
/roleplay	A simulation with feedback
/worksheet	A printable fill-in worksheet
/projectidea	A hands-on project that proves you understand it
/debate	Practice against the opposing argument
/casestudy	A case drill applying the framework
/grademe	Scored feedback on your answer
/steps	A numbered step-by-step method
/ifthen	Decision rules for real situations

Codes: 6. Visual and diagram outputs

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/timeline</code>	A chronological timeline
<code>/flowchart</code>	A process flowchart in mermaid syntax
<code>/table</code>	An organized comparison table
<code>/matrix</code>	A 2x2 matrix with labeled axes
<code>/orgchart</code>	The hierarchy as an indented text tree
<code>/venn</code>	A Venn diagram description
<code>/infographic</code>	A one-page infographic brief
<code>/diagramimage</code>	A labeled diagram image (needs image generation)
<code>/processmap</code>	A cause-and-effect chain with arrows
<code>/conceptmap</code>	A concept map in mermaid syntax

Codes: 7. Teach me and Feynman

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/feynman</code>	A Feynman-technique explanation, plus the gaps
<code>/teachback</code>	A tutor that corrects your explanation
<code>/socratic</code>	Progressive Socratic questioning
<code>/dumbquestions</code>	10 beginner questions, answered
<code>/explainlikeexpert</code>	An explanation at three levels
<code>/whatif</code>	5 what-if questions that stress-test the idea
<code>/translate</code>	Dense text turned into plain language
<code>/steelman</code>	The strongest possible version of the argument
<code>/gaps</code>	Topics the book leaves unexplained that you would need to know
<code>/interrogate</code>	An interview roleplay with the author

Codes: 8. Exam and test prep

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/studyguide</code>	A full structured study guide
<code>/examquestions</code>	10 predicted exam questions
<code>/mcq</code>	10 multiple-choice questions with an answer key
<code>/shortanswer</code>	8 short-answer questions with model answers
<code>/essayprompts</code>	5 essay prompts with outlines
<code>/cheatsheet</code>	A one-page condensed summary
<code>/highyield</code>	The priority points most likely to be tested
<code>/markingguide</code>	An examiner rubric and criteria
<code>/mockexam</code>	A timed mock exam with answers
<code>/weakspots</code>	Tracks missed questions and builds a review list

Codes: 9. Notes and organization

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/cornell</code>	Cornell notes format
<code>/outline</code>	A hierarchical outline
<code>/markdownnotes</code>	Clean Markdown formatting
<code>/notion</code>	A Notion-ready page layout
<code>/index</code>	A book index with topic locations
<code>/tagsystem</code>	Tags and categories for a second brain
<code>/studysheet</code>	Your notes merged with chapter content
<code>/revisioncards</code>	One idea per card
<code>/summaryladder</code>	A summary at three lengths: line, paragraph, page
<code>/keyvalue</code>	Structured label: value facts

Codes: 10. Apply it to your life

CODE	WHAT IT DOES
/actionplan	A 30-day action plan
/applytome	The ideas applied to your personal situation
/habits	5 daily or weekly habits
/worktemplate	A reusable work template
/decisionrules	A real-life decision guide
/firstthreesteps	The first 3 actions to take
/metrics	Ways to measure success
/pitfalls	Common mistakes when applying it
/reflection	5 journaling prompts
/teachsomeone	A 5-minute lesson plan

Five full-power codes

These five run a longer, multi-part version of the idea.

CODE	WHAT YOU GET
/studysystem	A complete system: overview, the 10 highest-yield points, a glossary, 15 flashcards, a 10-question quiz and a 7-day study schedule
/mockexam	A timed exam with 10 multiple-choice questions, 4 short-answer questions and 1 essay with an outline, with the answer key at the bottom
/socratic	Socratic tutoring one question at a time, tracking where you struggle and ending with a review list
/actionplan	Weekly themes with 2 to 3 specific actions per week, progress metrics, and one core habit to finish on
/feynman	The simplest explanation, with vague spots flagged. You explain it back and it corrects you until a beginner could follow

Tips for better results

- Paste the text, chapter or PDF before you type the code. For a well-known book, give the title and author.
- The free ChatGPT tier handles every text output.
- Mermaid diagrams and image generation need paid features.
- Open mermaid code in Canvas to see the diagram rendered.

When the result is off

PROBLEM	FIX
The mind map misses a topic you care about	Run /mindmap again and name the topic in your message so it gets its own branch.
The notes feel too broad	Say which chapter or section you want, then run the command again.
The flashcards cover too much	Ask for cards on one chapter at a time.
The comic page does not land the idea	State the single main idea in your own words and run /educationalcomics again.

Ready to go deeper?

This free guide is just the beginning.

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